

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

Birth reflects an extreme prematurity . At approximately 28 - 32 weeks gestational age , human infants are born with a cortex whose neurons are incompletely myelinated and have relatively few synapses ; they rely heavily on subcortical structures , such as the thalamus and brain stem , to process and initiate basic arousal , feeding , and reflexive responses . These deeper nuclei are more mature and functioning by birth , which aligns them as the least “underdeveloped” among brain systems . By contrast , the neocortex is largely immature : neurons are immature and lacking myelin , and synapse formation is sparse ; the cerebellum , thalamus , basal ganglia , and limbic system (including hypothalamus) are more developed but not as evolutionarily ancient or , at birth , as functionally mature as brain stem and thalamus .

Correct answer: D . brain stem

</think>

<answer>

D . brain stem

</answer>

